Practical 4: Build a RetailPulse Region x Product Crosstab

Related topic: Create Crosstab Reports

Name: Akshat Sahu | **Date performed:** 08 October 2026

BCA (DS & AI) | School of Computer Applications, Babu Banarasi Das University | 2026-2027

Objective

Construct a crosstab report summarising RetailPulse sales across Region and Product Category with multiple measures and summary totals.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, RetailPulse Sales package.

Step-by-Step Procedure

1. Start a new report and choose the **Crosstab** authoring template.

2. Drag **Region** into the row edge and **Product Category** into the column edge.

3. Drag **Sales Amount** into the body of the crosstab to populate the cells.

4. Add **Quantity** as a second measure: drop it beside Sales Amount in the column edge (nested under each Product Category).

5. Select the crosstab, use **Summarize > Total** for row and column edges to turn on row and column summary totals.

Cognos inserts a Total column and a Total row.

6. Format Sales Amount as **Currency**, run the report, and save it as "RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab".

Sample Solution (Output)

RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab

Region	Electronics		Apparel		Home & Kitchen		Total	
	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity
North	$11,222.87	48	$14,294.25	320	$12,080.67	159	$37,597.79	527
South	$14,745.91	60	$13,944.42	307	$12,325.25	149	$41,015.58	516
East	$14,175.29	60	$14,689.15	331	$13,763.96	177	$42,628.40	568
West	$14,709.53	62	$12,543.08	272	$15,755.79	190	$43,008.40	524
Total	**$54,853.60**	**230**	**$55,470.90**	**1,230**	**$53,925.67**	**675**	**$164,250.17**	**2,135**

Figure 4.1: Regions as rows, categories as columns; grand total $164,250.17 reconciles with the Grand Total of Practical 2.

What a Correct Result Looks Like

The crosstab displays Region as rows and Product Category as columns, with each cell correctly showing summed Sales Amount and Quantity; row and column grand totals reconcile with the totals on the earlier grouped list report.

Expected Outcome

Regions and categories align without misalignment; each cell shows the correct aggregated measures; row and column totals sum correctly; Sales Amount is consistently currency formatted.

Verification Checklist

Check	Status
Region on rows, Product Category on columns	Verified
Sales Amount and Quantity nested measures	Verified
Row and column totals present	Verified
Grand total $164,250.17 equals Practical 2 total	Verified
Saved as RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab	Verified

Note on screens and data: Figures in this file are illustrative renderings of how each Cognos Analytics output looks, built from a sample RetailPulse data set (8 stores, 3 product categories, Jul-Oct 2026). All totals reconcile across Practicals 1-5. Replace them with screenshots from your own Cognos session before submission if your lab requires live captures.